

RAAHI

"हर गली एक कहानी है" — *Every lane has a story*

A gamified travel companion for India, painted in the colours of a highway dhaba signboard and a grandmother's carpet — turning tourists into *raahi* (राही, "travellers on the path") who explore real streets, meet real people, and put real money into the local economy.

Quest-driven travel

Local-first economy

Crowd & footfall balancing

Scroll-native storytelling

Play → Explore → Discover → Spend Locally → Earn → Continue

Concept adapted from the "Destination Quest" tourism note

v1.0 · Basic Prototype Scope

01 · BRAND & VISION

The Idea, in One Line

RAAHI is not a tourism app that added a game. It's a game *painted onto* a real trip — using signboard-bright visuals, hand-painted typography and street-level storytelling to pull tourists off the "top-10 checklist" and into the actual texture of a place: its bazaars, its artisans, its dhabas, its back lanes.

The name comes from **राही (raahi)** — Hindi/Urdu for "wayfarer" or "one who walks the path." It sets the emotional register for the whole product: not a tourist ticking boxes, but a traveller earning a story.

Why this visual identity

The rug (background system)

- Deep red/maroon Persian-carpet motif used as the base atmosphere of the site — evokes a dhaba, a haveli courtyard, a home.
- Used full-bleed on hero/landing sections and as a texture accent on section dividers — never behind long text blocks, to protect readability.
- Paired with a navy-ink overlay so content "floats" above it like a painted signboard at night.

The signboard wordmark

- RAAHI is set in a thick, hand-painted slab style — pink/coral fill, navy outline, soft drop shadow — echoing hand-painted Bollywood-era shop and movie signboards.
- This treatment is reserved for the logo and hero headlines only; body copy uses a clean grotesque (Poppins) so the product still reads as usable software, not just a poster.

Design principle: nostalgic, hand-painted *surface*, modern, fast, frictionless *product*. The rug and the signboard font create warmth and place; the actual UI underneath stays clean so quests are easy to read and act on.

Core loop

PLAY → EXPLORE → DISCOVER → SPEND LOCALLY → EARN → CONTINUE

02 · PROBLEM

What's Actually Broken Today

Tourists

- ✦ Default to the same famous, top-rated spots everyone else visits
- ✦ Never discover the hidden / locally authentic side of a place
- ✦ Trips collapse into "visit → photo → leave"
- ✦ Planning means hopping across five different apps and blogs
- ✦ No itinerary adapts to crowding, weather or real-time conditions

Local businesses & artisans

- ✦ Little to no marketing budget or digital presence
- ✦ Genuinely good shops stay invisible to tourists walking right past them
- ✦ Demand is unpredictable, day to day

Hotels & homestays

- ✦ Reduced to "a place to sleep," with no natural hook into local experiences
- ✦ Need more direct bookings, longer stays, better guest engagement

Local transport

- ✦ Waits on unpredictable tourist movement instead of knowing where demand is
- ✦ Never integrated into the itinerary itself

Tourism boards

- ✦ Footfall concentrates on a handful of famous sites → overcrowding, traffic, strain
- ✦ Revenue distributes unevenly; nearby areas see almost none of it

The pattern underneath all five problems: everyone — tourist, shopkeeper, hotel, driver, and city — is operating on incomplete, undistributed information about where interest and footfall actually are. RAAHI's job is to route both.

03 · SOLUTION

RAAHI Quests — From Checklist to Journey

Instead of a static "Top 10 places" list, RAAHI builds each traveller a personal, story-driven quest line — and every completed quest quietly redistributes footfall, spend and attention across five stakeholder groups at once.

Stakeholder	What they get from RAAHI
Tourist ("Raahi")	A personalised, surprising, low-effort trip that feels like a story, not a spreadsheet
Local businesses	Real footfall, visibility, and measurable demand from tourists already nearby
Hotels / homestays	Higher engagement, longer stays, and a natural bridge into local experiences via "Quest Hubs"
Local transport	Predictable, forecastable demand instead of waiting on luck
Tourism boards	Live crowd data and destination-level intelligence to manage overcrowding

The quest loop

- 1 Pick your vibe** — Fun & Chill, Adventure, Culture & History, Foodie, Nature, Photography, Family, Budget Explorer, Learn & Explore. Multi-select — e.g. "Culture + Food + Photography."
- 2 Get a story-driven quest line** — not a flat itinerary, but a sequence: a landmark at 10am, a local breakfast at noon, an artisan meeting at 2pm, a hidden viewpoint at 4pm, a sunset ritual at 6pm.
- 3 Accept a quest** — e.g. "Find the 100-year-old haveli hidden behind the spice market," worth Raahi Credits.
- 4 Follow narrative clues** — turn-by-turn navigation wrapped in storytelling ("look for the red-roofed building beside the old bazaar") instead of a flat pin-drop.
- 5 Do the real-world action** — discover a hidden spot, try local food, learn a story and answer a question, support a local business, or explore an under-visited attraction.
- 6 Verify & earn** — QR scan, merchant confirmation, GPS check-in, or photo verification; credits + progress unlock instantly, and the next nearby quest appears.

Dynamic quests — the crowd-control engine

Without RAAHI

- Tourist arrives at a landmark, finds it overcrowded
- Waits in a queue, or leaves disappointed
- Same problem repeats tomorrow; nearby shops see zero footfall

With RAAHI

- System detects crowding in real time
- Surfaces higher-reward quests nearby — a hidden trail, a village walk, an artisan lane
- Tourists follow the incentive, not a warning label — crowd disperses on its own

Crowding → dynamic reward → redistribution → more local footfall. This is the mechanism, not decoration — it's the same demand-balancing logic from the underlying tourism concept note, wired directly into the reward engine.

04 · DESIGN LANGUAGE

Visual & Motion System

Palette

Primary

- Carpet Maroon #7A1026
- Signboard Navy #1C1440
- Marigold Gold #FFD38A

Accent

- Signboard Pink #FF7A8D
- Parchment Cream #FDF3EA
- Terracotta #C98A2E

Typography

Display / wordmark / hero headlines: hand-painted slab (Alfa Slab One or equivalent), pink fill with navy outline & soft shadow — reserved for the RAAHI logo and big moments (hero line, level-up moments, quest-complete banners).

Section headers / quest cards: a rounded, friendly bold display (Baloo) — playful without tipping into "kids' app."

Body / UI / forms: Poppins — clean and highly legible on both the rug background and plain cards.

Handwritten accents: a marker-style script (Kalam) for "diary" captions on polaroids and quest notes — reinforces the scrapbook feeling.

Imagery direction

- ♦ Hero and section backgrounds: the red carpet/rug motif, used full-bleed with a dark gradient overlay for text contrast — never diluted into generic stock texture.
- ♦ Hero **illustrated ambient-motion market scene** (bazaar stall, pottery, cycle-rickshaw, cat, brass pots) as a short looping video — see Section 5 for exact placement.
- ♦ Scroll-triggered **hanging polaroid strip** of Indian culture shots — temples, street food, festivals, handicrafts, transport — pinned to a string with a clothes-peg, swinging slightly on scroll.
- ♦ Quest-card thumbnails and location photography should favour warm, golden-hour, slightly grainy tones to match the rug/signboard palette rather than cool corporate photography.



Reference frame from the supplied ambient market-motion clip — used as the partial-height hero video on the landing page (see Section 5).

05 · LANDING PAGE SPEC

The First Screen

Layout, top to bottom

Zone	Spec
Nav bar	Transparent over rug background; RAAHI wordmark (small) left, "Start My Journey" pill button right.
Hero	Full-bleed dark rug background. Left: eyebrow + headline in signboard font ("Har Gali Ek Kahani Hai") + one-line subhead + CTA. Right / lower-half: the ambient market video plays inside a contained frame — roughly 55–65% of viewport width, ~45% of viewport height — <i>not</i> full-bleed, so it reads as a "window into the street" rather than a background wash. Rounded corners, thin navy border, subtle drop shadow so it feels like a painted frame hung on the rug.
Prompt strip	"What kind of story do you want to create?" — single input / vibe-picker teaser, echoing Section 4 of the quest flow.
Scroll section 1 — Polaroid clothesline	A horizontal "string" (SVG line) crosses the section; 5–7 polaroid photos of Indian culture (temple, dhaba, rickshaw, festival colour, handicraft) are clipped to it with tiny peg icons. As the user scrolls into view, each polaroid animates in with a slight rotation + drop, as if just pinned up, staggered ~100ms apart.
Scroll section 2 — Problem → Solution	Short, punchy restatement of Section 2/3 above, two or three cards.
Scroll section 3 — How a quest works	4-step horizontal or stacked flow (Accept → Follow clues → Do the thing → Earn & unlock next) with light iconography.
Stakeholder strip	Five small cards — Tourist / Business / Hotel / Transport / Tourism board — each one line of value.
Footer CTA	Rug background returns; wordmark large, "Start My Journey" repeated, social/contact.

Motion principle: the rug is the only element that's ever "loud." Everything the user actually interacts with (buttons, quest cards, forms) sits on clean cream or white panels above it — so the page feels rich and cultural without becoming hard to read or slow to use.

06 · PROTOTYPE SCOPE

What's In the Basic Prototype (v1)

In scope

Build

- Landing page: hero with framed video, polaroid scroll section, problem/solution, quest-flow explainer, stakeholder strip, footer
- "Plan your trip" form (destination, duration, party, vibe multi-select) — static/mock destinations (start with 1–2, e.g. Jaipur / Shimla)
- Mock quest feed: 4–6 sample quests with clue text, reward credits, a "complete quest" button (mock verification)
- Simple progress state: credits earned, quests completed, a level label — kept in local component state, no auth required
- Responsive down to mobile (single-column, video hero shrinks but stays "framed," not full-bleed)

Not in v1

- Real GPS/QR verification, payments, or live business dashboards
- Login/auth, backend, or persisted user accounts
- Tourism-board live dashboard (mock a single static screenshot/section instead)
- Real destination data beyond the 1–2 seeded demo cities
- Dynamic crowd-detection logic — can be simulated with a toggle ("simulate crowding") for the demo

Success criteria for the prototype

- ✦ A reviewer can land on the page, understand the concept in under 10 seconds from the hero alone
- ✦ Scrolling feels alive (polaroid reveal, section transitions) without feeling gimmicky or slow
- ✦ The quest loop (accept → clue → complete → reward → next quest) is demoable end-to-end with mock data
- ✦ Visual identity is unmistakably distinct from generic travel-app templates

NEXT: PAIR THIS PRD WITH THE RAAHI ANTIGRAVITY BUILD PROMPT TO SCAFFOLD THE WORKING PROTOTYPE.